

this would weaken the Union armies to the point of war-weariness but preserve precious Southern manpower.

“... a **rock of steadiness** when sometimes in battle the world seemed **flying to pieces.**”

G. MOXLEY SORREL, CONFEDERATE STAFF OFFICER, ON LONGSTREET

Missed opportunities

Now in formal command of Lee's First Corps, Longstreet missed the campaign at Chancellorsville while on detached duty with two of his divisions near Suffolk, Virginia. He gathered much-needed supplies and contained the Federal threat to southside Virginia, but lamented a lost opportunity to shift his divisions either to Lee's army or to Bragg's in Tennessee, where they might have had a decisive bearing on the war.

At Gettysburg in July 1863, Longstreet was wary and delayed his assaults on July 2 and July 3, quite possibly because he felt Lee had unreasonably rejected his proposal to move around the flank of the Federal Army and reposition between it and Washington. He was convinced that the attack on the Union center, sometimes called Longstreet's Assault, but better known as Pickett's Charge, was doomed to failure.

Later war years

After Gettysburg, Longstreet transferred with most of his corps to Bragg's Army of Tennessee. After a 775-mile (1,240km) ride on ramshackle railroads, he and his men arrived at a timely moment at Chickamauga. His wing poured through a gap in the Federal lines, routed half the Union army, and created the greatest Southern victory in the Western Theater. In November 1863, Longstreet independently led his command in the ill-fated Knoxville